

Meditations XI.19

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This section is a brief synopsis of how to analyze and judge one's thoughts, determining whether they are good and worthy to be continued, or whether the thoughts ought to be corrected. It goes:

Tell yourself:

- This thought is unnecessary.
- This one is destructive to the people around you.
- This wouldn't be what you really think.
- {paraphrased} The more divided part of you has been beaten and subdued by the degraded mortal part – the body and its self-indulgence.

The Stoic value of this quote is in emphasizing control and sovereignty over your mind (and only that, really). The first point goes to minimizing the complexity of our concerns and thought lives, not worrying about or thinking on things we needn't concern ourselves with, like those things we can't control. The second fits with the Stoic value of unity with and allegiance to Nature, and the common human good. The third is somewhat more obscure, but I think it has to do with unconsidered thoughts or impressions, that it is an idea or assumption that you would not hold if you thought about it. Finally, live up to the highest in you, and the highest you know. You have been given a mind and great mental ability by God, live up to it.